

T. NAGAR

Saidapet » West Mambalam » Vadapalani » Porur » Kattupakkam » Irungattukottai » Nungambakkam » Manapakkam » Ashok Nagar » Valasaravakkam
Gerugambakkam » Mangadu » Choolaimedu » Egmore » K K Nagar » Kodambakkam » Virugambakkam » Somangalam » Poonamalee » Chetpet

‘Cobwebs’ of telecom cables in Mugaliwakkam



G. KRISHNAN

Telecommunication cables have entwined the posts of street lamps at AGS Colony in Mugaliwakkam with some of these cables dangling and some others, lying on the roads and footpaths.

This situation poses a serious threat to the safety of road users, especially during the rainy season. Greater Chennai Corporation should address this issue.

The neighbourhood falls under Ward 156 in Zone 12 - Alandur.

G. Krishnan, AGS Colony, Phase -Three Residents Welfare Association, president, Mugaliwakkam



Some of the street lamp posts at AGS Colony in Mugaliwakkam. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

You can be our **volunteer writer**

Dear readers, you can be our volunteer-writer by writing to us about issues and events in your neighbourhood. You should send the write-ups to downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in. Letters must carry the contact number.



Saligramam RWA seeks speed breakers on key interior roads

The speed breakers on key interior roads at Kaveri Rangan Nagar in Saligramam were painted recently. These roads include Pillayar Kovil Street, Durai Arasan Street, MGR Street and Abu Salai Street. This was done following a meeting between Kaveri Rangan Nagar Residents Welfare Association and R-5 Virugambakkam Police Station - Traffic recently.

S. Shankar, Sub-Inspector - Traffic from the station took part in the meeting. “The speed breakers were laid many months ago but were not painted. We thank the Sub-Inspector for the prompt action now. The colony also needs additional speed breakers,” says N.S. Ramachandran, an active member of the Association.

During the meet, the Association also highlighted the issue of vehicles lying abandoned for months and unauthorised parking.

EXQUISITE SHOWCASE OF BANGLES FESTIVAL of BANGLES

A TATA PRODUCT



TANISHQ

UP TO **20% OFF***
on making charges of gold jewellery
and on diamond value

FLAT **0% DEDUCTION***
ON EXCHANGE
of old gold as low as 9 karat,
on purchase of diamond jewellery

FROM 21st TO 30th AUGUST 2026

Talk to our jewellery expert to know more ☎ 1800 2966 677 Buy online at tanishq.co.in or Download our App 📱 *Conditions apply, For T&C visit our website.

Showroom : No. 46, North Usman Road, T. Nagar, Chennai. Tel: 98949 99390, 78248 87071.
📍 113 & 114 Mena Kampala Arcade, Sir Thyagaraya Road, Parthasarathi Puram, T. Nagar, Tel: 98421 34515, 99622 00090.



KODAMBAKKAM

2 & 3 BHK
Ultra Luxury
Apartment

988 Sq.Ft to 1330 Sq.Ft
ON 40 FEET ROAD

**ZERO WASTAGE
FLOOR PLAN**



CC OBTAINED



Fully Vasthu



Lift Till Terrace



CCTV Cameras



Generator



EV Charging Points



Car and Bike
Covered Parking

FEW UNITS LEFT



FOR BOOKING CONTACT : **72 00 00 94 14**

VOORA VENTURES

‘Grey water overflow near Metro Rail station’

P. SENTHIL KUMAR

The 30-feet street (commonly known as Community Hall Road or Mudhal Sandhu) behind Iyyappanthangal metro rail station is known for recurrent overflow of grey water. It is also an approach road to Mount Poonamallee Road, a State Highway, and therefore witnesses heavy traffic movement. The metro train service from Poonamallee to Vadapalani via Iyyappanthangal and Porur is expected to be opened soon. Then this street will assume greater importance witnessing an increase in vehicular and pedestrian movement. Therefore, Iyyappanthangal Village Panchayat authorities should take necessary measures to end this issue.

P. Senthil Kumar is a resident of Iyyappanthangal



Community Hall Road near Iyyappanthangal metro railway station.
PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

‘Water leakage in Soundarajan Street’

P. SURESH

A pool of water on the road has become a common sight in Soundarajan Street, off Venkat Narayana Road in T. Nagar, suggesting water leakage from the underground drinking water pipe. This has been the case for the past six months. It may be noted that there is an electricity transformer nearby. Chennai Metropolitan Water Supply & Sewerage Board should attend to this issue at the earliest.

P. Suresh is a resident of T. Nagar



Soundarajan Street, off Venkat Narayana Road, T. Nagar.
PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

‘Increase the frequency of S26 and S86 buses’



Small buses S86 and S26 near Ashok Nagar metro railway station. FILE PHOTO

P. SUDHAKAR

The frequency of small bus services S26 and S86 need to be improved.

S26 connects Ashok Pillar junction and Valasarawakkam covering Ramapuram, Nesapakkam, and K.K. Nagar.

And the bus service S86 connects DLF IT Park on Mount Poonamallee High Road and T. Nagar bus terminus via Ramapuram, K.K. Nagar and Ashok Nagar. It may be noted that Ramapuram is poorly served by MTC buses. Residents of interior areas of Ramapuram

have to come to Mount Poonamallee High Road to access buses which is quite a distance away.

Both the bus services have a stop near the Ashok Nagar metro railway station.

These two services receive very good patronage and that could be witnessed during peak hours when the buses are overcrowded. But their frequency leaves a lot to be desired. I request Metropolitan Transport Corporation to increase their frequency at least during peak hours.

P. Sudhakar is a resident of West Jafferkhanpet

‘Auto lying abandoned in West Mambalam’

A. S. THIRUMALAI

This autorickshaw, as seen in this image, is lying at Vinayagam Street in West Mambalam for several months now.

The exact spot is near Anu apartment.

The vehicle is being misused for alcohol consumption, smoking, and unlawful activities.

Residents find it quite unsafe.

Greater Chennai Corporation should look into this issue.

A. S. Thirumalai is a resident of West Mambalam



MIGRAINE

Advertisement

A migraine is a severe, throbbing headache usually on one side of the head that makes high sensitiveness to light and sound that causes nausea.

Migraine affects approximately 12% to 15% of the global population.

In India the pooled prevalence of migraine is approximately 18% to 25%

Peaking between 35 and 45 years of age.

Skew toward women and young adults in their productive working years.

The two main types are migraine **without aura** (sudden, severe pain) and migraine with aura (pain preceded by warning signs like flashing lights (or) tingling).

The chemicals cause blood vessels around the brain to widen. These vessels pull on the sensitive nerve endings, which results in the classic throbbing, pulsing headache.

4 Main Types of Migraine

1. Classic Migraine starts with early warning signs called a prodrome these include visual disturbances like flashing zig zag lines, blind spots, dizziness (or) ringing ears. It can also cause mood changes extreme thirst, or sweet cravings before the headache starts.

2. Common Migraine starts suddenly without any early warnings though it still features nausea & vomiting

3. Complicated Migraine this will cause neurological issues like numbness tingling or weakness on one side of the body. They can also cause vision changes and speech problems these symptoms usually disappear completely

Basilar Migraine - A type causing double vision dizziness (or) confusion sometime, these neurological symptoms happen without any actual headache

4. Cluster Headache these are highly painful; steady headaches that occur mostly in men. They wake people up from sleep.

In homoeopathy symptoms are categorized into 3 types based on intensity and severity of symptoms.

Homoeopathy approach- types:

Type -I Simple - pain with associated cardinal gradual symptoms. Aura present

Type-II Complex - Intensity duration and frequency will be slightly higher than the type-I with gradual recovery

Type-III Severe - complicated with numbness and tingling of the lips, nausea and vomiting.

On regular constitutional medicine (GCS) recovery will be possible.

Medicines are prescribed according to individual characteristics of the person (**Individualization**) such as **Intellect, Mental** and **Physical attributes**.

This treatment initially reduces the intensity and frequency of symptoms then eventually lead to recovery of the diseases.

Our clinic is named

PRANAVAA HOLISTIC HOMEO CLINIC & RESEARCH CENTRE.

It is located near

Coral spring apartment, RR colony Jafferkhanpet, Ashok Nagar, Chennai and in

Reliance apartment, Near central bus stand, Trichy

RR -Nagar, Near PPDS, Thanjavur

and we are doing our services.



Ticking on behind the barricades

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

Zenith Watch Co at
Kutchery Road in
Mylapore.

Somewhere between the ticking of a century-old pendulum clock and a modern, sleek wrist watch, Zenith Watch Co. on Kutchery Road has ensured two distinct eras of time live side by side. A sweep of the eye taking in the walls of this shop that stares at Metro Rail barricades presents this sumptuous display of the past and the present. The walls are decorated with old, ornate timepieces, repaired and ready for delivery; and these walls also display shelves holding modern wristwatches out of factories and packed ready for sale.

Since 1954, this shop at Kutchery Road, near Luz signal in Mylapore, has been serving customers seeking to preserve timepieces of the past, hallowed by their personal memories, as well as watches and clocks just out of the blocks and dew-fresh in the market.

Founded by Mallick Pasha, the shop has never had a change of address. And even in these difficult times, when Metro Rail work has redrawn pathways, both for pedestrians and motorists, the shop resiliently stays put at this address. Mahaboob Pasha, who runs this family business, points out that even old customers accustomed to walking through the doors of this shop struggle to find their way to those familiar doors, as Metro Rail work has engineered a maze of new pathways through route diversions and blockages. By virtue of the diversity of its services, Zenith depends on revisits by old customers as well as walk-ins by new ones. The “barricades” across Luz Corner, on Kutchery Road and Luz Church Road hinder both processes.



“New customers find it difficult to notice the shop, while the old ones find it difficult to reach the shop,” he says.

But Mahaboob sounds like someone who has taken these challenges in his stride. At 58, this man has spent more than three decades amidst the “chimes of time”, having taken over the reins of the shop when he was in his twenties. Back then for this M.Com graduate, there was no dearth of career options. “This is a family business and I cannot leave it; hence I chose this,” he says. There was a time when he worked alongside the technicians at the shop, as a repairer of timepieces. Today, he sticks to

the management side of the business, leaving the repair of broken and malfunctioning timepieces to the technicians on the rolls. Mahaboob notes spare parts are sourced from Mumbai and Delhi when they are unavailable locally.

On whether a plethora of other devices marking time such as the mobile phone, the laptop and so on have made a dent in the attraction of the wristwatch, his answer is an emphatic ‘no’. Mahaboob observes that it remains firmly where it belongs: on the wrist. Largely for inveterate followers and buyers of new wristwatch models, Zenith stocks up on non-branded wristwatches, largely wallet-friendly.

On retaining his old customer base, Mahaboob notes hospitality on the other side of the counter remains an effective glue keeping that loyalty intact. While valuing face-to-face, in-person interactions, Zenith has ensured the connections are sustained by technology. Its website allows customers to track repairs using their bill numbers; it showcases wristwatches, wall clocks, and other timepieces for sale. So, what is it that sustains Zenith as it is hemmed in by Metro Rail barricades? This probably: keeping stride with technology without losing that personal, human touch.

Celebrating Madras Day (August 22), Resilience Series tracks old markets and enterprises in the city that are under the shadow of a major civic infrastructure work but are soldiering on with inimitable poise.



“New customers find it difficult to notice the shop, while the old ones find it difficult to reach the shop.”

Established in 1954, seller and mender of timepieces Zenith Watch Co at Kutchery Road in Mylapore has never had a change of address. In recent times, it has been facing a massive challenge on account of route diversions and road blockages caused by Metro Rail work. The enterprise however seems to have taken this difficulty in its stride. A little distance away, on the same road is a one-man enterprise Peer & Sons, established in 1963, that repairs watches and clocks; and it displays similar fortitude



Alone with the timepieces

At Peer & Sons on Kutchery Road, a son is keeping his father’s memory alive by enthusiastically practising a skill imparted to him by the senior

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN

On that part of Kutchery Road, where the Buckingham Canal flows sluggishly under a bridge, S. Shakil Ahmed operates from a shop smaller than a niche in a dovecote. The shop was once larger, recalls Shakil, but as the owner reclaimed a part of it for another enterprise, it shrunk to its present dimensions. But this small shop still catches the eye for its wall displays: clocks, either *demode* or delectably antique, depending on the eye beholding them. Another eye-catching feature is the enseigne above the entrance that announces the enterprise as Peer & Sons. When quizzed about the name and its homonymic alignment with the iconic P. Orr & Sons on Mount Road, Shakil sounds a tad amused as he offers a reply: obviously, when they see this shop, they know the two are galaxies apart. But when they hear the name ‘Peer & Sons’ over the phone, they would be confused for a split second. And the name was not carefully chosen to evoke that iconic shop, remarks Shakil, just to reflect that it was started by his father S.K. Peer.

S.K. Peer had opened this shop in 1963 and continued in the saddle till his demise in 2008. Shakil relishes reminiscing about the unquestioning obedience with which he followed in his father’s footsteps, not in 2008 but way back in 1991 when the senior was at the height of his prowess as a mender of timepieces and he was just a school student. Shakil joined his father as his understudy in 1991, right after finishing his Class X board exams.

“I did not even wait for my results,” he says with a faint laugh at the memory.

“If my father asked for something, it was always a yes,” states Shakil, his decision driven by a straightforward logic: if his father needed him at the shop, that was reason enough to be there.

He observes that for parents to get a ‘yes’ from their children today, they would have to first answer a gazillion ‘whys’. Shakil, who has three children, two girls and a boy, all of them falling within the Gen Z bracket, is at peace with the current generation’s questioning mindset as they are spoilt for choice in terms of career options, and have information at hand to suss those careers out.

To a question if he ever regrets not having taken a different career path, Shakil’s answer is a ‘no’, but he qualifies it by admitting that on rare occasions,



S. Shakil Ahmed at Peer & Sons on Kutchery Road.

the thought has crossed his mind. That thought most likely occurred during the pandemic and in recent times, on account of Metro Rail work at the Luz Corner (where Kutchery Road meets Luz Church Road meet) restricting access to his shop. That thought gets counterbalanced by his awareness of the benefits of being one’s own boss.

“If there is a function, I can attend it without prior leave complications; if I want to travel, I can take a few days off and do so,” he smiles.

He has commendably built a livelihood just by the practice of the craft of repairing timepieces, has managed to give his children good and meaningful education (the two daughters are in college and the son in school).

After his father’s death in 2008, Shakil has been running the shop in a veritable one-man show spending that vast chunk of his waking hours (that is, from 10.a.m. to 9p.m.), sitting hunched over timepieces, peering at them through a magnifying eyepiece. The punch-in punch-out time is sometimes longer: during the pandemic, he began taking delicate and major repairs home, a habit that has stuck with him ever since. His workbench has witnessed everything from a Seiko to a 1960s Omega; and also those ornate tall, weight-driven pendulum clocks, colloquially called grandfather and grandmother clocks depending on their height and size. His customer base includes collectors of antique clocks. He accepts every timepiece that comes his way, from the grand to the commonplace. Repairs of antique clocks can soak up considerable time.

Availability of spare parts can sometimes pose a challenge. When unable to find spare parts, he has fashioned them himself, says Shakil. But obviously, there is a limit to what you can fashion yourself; the sustainable option is to have dealers who can hand them over to you. On a normal day though, he sources spares from dealers. He also buys old clocks to salvage those parts that are in working order.

Now, the question that stares at any enterprise sustained by successive generations. Would the next generation take the baton from Shakil and continue the legacy started by his father S.K. Peer? His children might likely choose different fields, and Shakil admits the possibility of the business continuing through them being thin. For now, Shakil remains at his bench, turning back time by getting old timepieces ticking again. And he luxuriates in the sweet sound of a timepiece ticking and sounding back to life.

Free and subsidised dialysis service providers in Chennai



LIFFY THOMAS

16 and counting

It was after a stint in Canada that nephrologist Georgi Abraham decided to start a dialysis centre at Chennai in the mid-2000s.

The Tanker Foundation Dialysis Centre started in a humble way at Georgi Abraham’s father-in-law’s house on Poonamalee High Road as it was lying vacant.

As the number of patients seeking dialysis began to shoot up, the Foundation sought a space at Rotary Ambattur Hospital where it got started on the initiative with five machines. Today, the upgraded hospital has 26 machines with 127 patients seeking dialysis under its care.

In the last two decades, this initiative to provide dialysis for patients twice or thrice a week has grown to serve people from various parts of Chennai and beyond. Dialysis is offered either free or at a subsidised rate of ₹ 375 to patients, says a note on its website.

Of the 16 centres run in Tamil Nadu by Tanker Foundation, 11 are in Chennai. “A majority of the patients are enrolled under the Chief Minister Scheme and if expenses beyond that need to be covered we find donors,” says Dr. Georgi Abraham, founder-president of the Tanker Foundation.

The patients have the choice of

opting for a centre that is closest to their home. “A patient whose kidney function is between 6 and 8 percent is eligible for dialysis, but we are particular that certain criteria are met including the financial background of the person and dialysis in an OP setting for free treatment,” says Dr. Georgi.

With rising number of kidney-related ailments, the Foundation sees a huge demand for this from of service. People who require early detection are those with high BP, history of diabetes, complaints of heart disease and a previous history of kidney disease.

For details about its various centres, visit <https://tankerfoundation.org>

***GCC-run centres

Greater Chennai Corporation runs dialysis centres in a majority of its zones. As per data put up on X, Zone IX has the maximum number of dialysis machines, 22. The unit functions from Vallorkottam Diagnostic Centre in Nungambakkam. Others are in Thiruvottiyur UCHC, Lakshmiapuram in Retteri UPHC, Elango Nagar UPHC, Padi Ambattur UCHC, Chinnai Porur in Valsarvakam UCHC; Perungudi, Injambakkam and Semmacherry UCHC;

These centres are operated with the support of NGOs and organisations. Dialysis treatment is offered free-of-cost at these centres.

Care at ₹ 600

Since Chennai Lions Dialysis Foundation started in Thiruvanniyur in 2011, one thing that has stayed constant is its affordable pricing. In all these 15 years, the Foundation charges ₹ 600 per sitting from those seeking dialysis.

Started as a pet project of Lion R. Ravichandran, Past District Governor, the Foundation offers dialysis treatment for close to 250 people a month at its six-bed dialysis centre.

The cost of a single haemodialysis session ranges from ₹1800 to ₹ 3,500 in city hospitals. “Since patients need to undergo dialysis sessions two to three times a week, the monthly cost of treatment can run into several thousand rupees. We started this service to alleviate some of the hardships faced by dialysis patients and their families,” says Ravichandran.

The remaining costs are covered by the Foundation. “Although we do face shortage of funds we have somehow been able to sustain this service with the support of donors,” he says.

Nephrologist R. Vijay Kumar is the consultant guiding the Foundation.

Chennai Lions Dialysis Foundation is at No 28A, South Mada Street, Thiruvanniyur, near Marundeeswarar Temple.

For details, call Ravichandran at 98410 51480/ Kalyani Ngarajan at 9841115984.

‘Cooking up’ a challenge for women chefs

Over 70 participants took part in this competition designed to test their culinary knowledge and kitchen skills

BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

This dish came to India from Indonesia, according to famous food historian KT Achaya. Cooks employed by Indonesian Hindu kings are believed to have made it between the 9th and 12th centuries. Name the dish.

* Designed by chemist Fred Baur using advanced computing to solve issues with broken and greasy-bagged snacks, this product's signature saddle-like shape is a mathematically optimised hyperbolic paraboloid. It comes packed in canisters to withstand transport pressure. Which engineered snack brand is this?

These two are among the questions that were posted to participants at QuizDiva, a culinary competition for women chefs, culinary professionals, and hospital-



The winners along with dignitaries at the event.

ity students from South India, held at Institute of Hotel Management in Taramani recently.

Over 70 participants found their knowledge and culinary skills tested through different rounds. There were three top prizes worth ₹ 1 lakh, ₹75,000 and ₹ 50,000 to be taken away.

Designed to celebrate talent, creativity, and professional excellence, the event organised by X Quiz IT with South India Chefs Association (SICA) as collaborators

tested the participants on practical culinary challenges, knowledge of food and kitchen skills.

The quiz segments were conducted by X Quiz IT's founder and creative head Arvind Rajeev, while the overall event was handled by Arun Jayakaran Ventures (AJV). "We have done quiz competitions for chefs in the past but this is the first time we were doing something exclusively for lady chefs who were in the fray to showcase their expertise in theo-

ry and practicals. We wanted them to look beyond the books," says quizzier Arvind Rajeev.

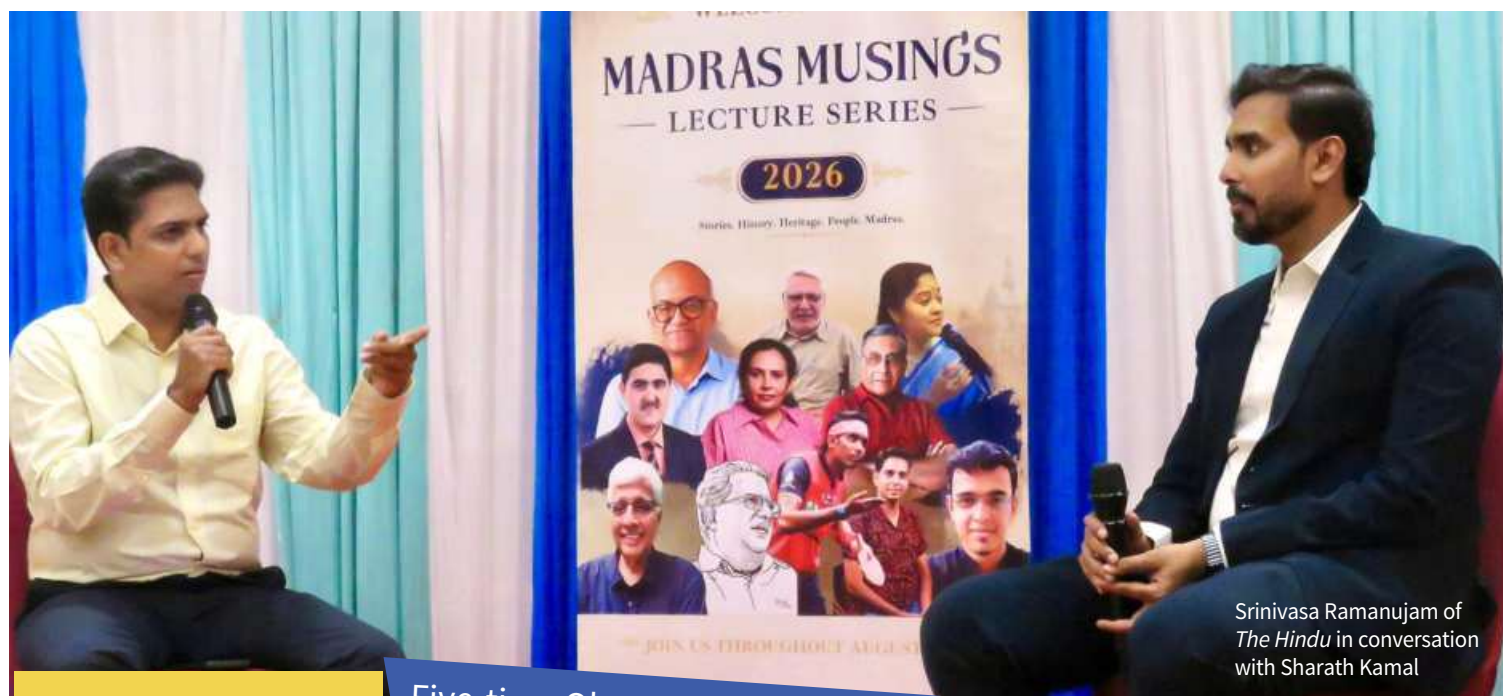
With women in the hospitality industry playing an important role, QuizDiva served as a platform for recognising and encouraging them.

Niranjana Murugesan Durai, a resident of Chennai, won the first prize. After a stint in the hotel industry, she is currently running her own home-based cloud kitchen and plans to use the cash

prize in her business.

Rubah Fathima and Nandhita Sriram were declared second and third prize winners respectively. A new experience for these chefs, the winners pointed out that having a quiz format in the challenge made them take "strategic guesses" and also admire the many female chefs in the industry.

Actor Thalaivasal Vijay was the special guest and he gave away the prizes.



Srinivasa Ramanujam of *The Hindu* in conversation with Sharath Kamal

From tracks to table

Five-time Olympian and table tennis legend Sharath Kamal shares his Madras memories

When table tennis champion Sharath Kamal watched *MS Dhoni: The Untold Story* (2016), he was almost in tears. Much like Dhoni, the now-popular paddler was once a railway TTE at the

Mambalam station in Madras. "There is a scene in the film that has Sushant Singh Rajput (who played Dhoni) sitting in a bench, watching trains go by and wondering if he would remain a ticket collector all his life. I have sat in sta-

tions in Madras exactly like that, before I saw success in table tennis," recalled Sharath.

One of India's most celebrated table tennis players, Sharath went down memory lane at 'The Sporting Side', part of the talks hosted by Madras Musings celebrating Madras Day.

In conversation with Srinivasa Ramanujam, Deputy Editor of *The*

Hindu (Metroplus), the five-time Olympian spoke about the times when he would cycle from Choolaimedu to Mylapore to attend training sessions. "I owe a lot of my success to the city's thriving table tennis culture. I had so many champions to look up to. The club culture here - where we focus on overall growth rather than just individual sporting growth - helped me hone my skills," he recalled.

Sharath, who studied at Padma Seshadri Bala Bhavan and Loyola College, went on to represent India at the highest level, becoming a force to reckon with in the world table tennis circuit. "I have always been a proud Chennaiite. During the time when I lived and trained in Europe, primarily Germany, I would miss the city and my mother's cooking a lot."

Now retired from table tennis, the champion is actively looking at giving back to the sport that gave him name and fame. Part of that will be his involvement in a High Performance centre at Melkottaiyur, a training facility dedicated to grooming future champions. "My unfulfilled dream was to win an Olympic medal for India in table tennis. We hope to achieve that through the younger generation of table tennis talents."

Promising tennis players get a leg up

Inspired by the Britannia Amritraj Tennis Program of the 1980s and 1990s, Next Level Program or NLP is supporting 10 top junior players from the state

BY A SPECIAL CORRESPONDENT

Vijay Amritraj, former international tennis star and president of the Tamil Nadu Tennis Association (TNTA), had high praise for the Next Level Program (NLP). The ambitious player-development initiative of TNTA seeks to provide comprehensive assistance to 10 of Tamil Nadu's top junior players, enabling them to pursue their tennis ambitions at the highest level.

Speaking at a press conference in Chennai recently to launch the WTA 250 Open International wo-



Next Level Program tennis players with the dignitaries.

men's tennis championship, to be held from November 2 to 8, the 72-year-old former Davis Cupper explained the idea behind NLP.

"You all have followed the NLP, which has been a great success so far. And it is great to see the enthusiasm that it has created for kids who want to get on board. We have an incredible sponsor (Bajaj Finserv) that has supported

it. And the sky is the limit for them. We are obviously targeting the four grand slams in the junior category," Vijay remarked.

The NLP kids are proving that they are making slow and gradual progress. At the recently concluded Junior National clay court championships at the Madras Cricket Club courts, NLP kids won all the four titles -- boys' singles,

girls' singles, boys' doubles and girls' doubles.

Launched in January 2024, NLP was conceived as a long-term player-development initiative by Amritraj and conceptualised and implemented by Rajeev Vijaykumar, who was brought in to lead player development at TNTA. Rajeev also serves as the Director and Head Coach of NLP.

"The support", highlighted by the release by NLP, "provided includes technical and on-court training, physical conditioning and fitness, mental and performance development, tournament travel and competition support, equipment and tennis accessories and mentorship and long-term player guidance.

According to the release, NLP is inspired by the highly successful Britannia Amritraj Tennis Program of the 1980s and 1990s, while adapting the model to the needs of today's players. Unlike the earlier program, NLP does not have a residential component and focuses exclusively on promising players from Tamil Nadu.

Some of the players who have benefited from NLP and performed well are Rethin Pranav Senthil Kumar, Diya Ramesh, Deepshika Vinayagamurthy and G. Rohit Hari Balaji.

While Rethin participated in all the four junior Grand Slam tournaments in 2025, Diya took part in the Australian Open Juniors in 2026.

Rohit Hari Balaji won the boys' singles title at the National juniors, while Deepshika Vinayagamurthy clinched the girls' singles title. Deepshika and Diya Ramesh won the girls' doubles crown and Rohit Hari Balaji and Srikar Doni from Karnataka won the boys' doubles title.

Baking workshop

Tamil Nadu Agricultural University Information & Training Centre is conducting a workshop on mushroom



cultivation on August 27. Another workshop on baking of cakes will be held on August 28. According to a press release, there will be demonstrations on making tea cake, banana walnut cake, ragi cake, gulab jamun cake, and coconut cake.

Both the sessions will be held at the centre's premises at Agro Tech Green Park, First Floor, Thiru. Vi. Ka. Industrial Estate, Guindy. Prior registration is required. For details, call 044 - 29530048

Chandragiri Fort and Madras

As part of Madras Week celebration, Storycorner at Bookmine is having a presentation on 'The Chandragiri Fort and its connection to the founding of Madras' on August 30; 9.30 a.m. at Hotel Palmgrove, Kodambakkam High Road. Sudha Umashanker, author, columnist and storyteller will be the speaker.

To register, Whatsapp 98402 47624



GUDUVANCHERRY
Pudupakkam Siruseri
PLOTS FOR SALE
PLOT SIZE FROM 600 SQ.FT. TO 2400 SQ.FT.
PRICE FROM ₹2300 SQ.FT. TO ₹6300 SQ.FT.
Ph: 73053 30728

BUYING
WORKING AND NOT WORKING, A/C, BRASS, STAINLESS STEEL, FRIDGE, OLD COMPUTER, LAPTOP, UPS, BATTERIES, MUSIC SYSTEM, WATER HEATER, GYM ITEMS, WOODEN FURNITURE, SOFAS, COT, BEURO, DINING SET, ALL A TO Z SCRAPS
A TO Z HOUSE HOLD ITEMS
VANITHA TRADERS
96001 01534
No Visiting Charges

SOFA SERVICE
WE UNDERTAKE:
1 Any Sofa's
2 Any Recliner Sofa's
3 Any Cushions
4 Reupholstery
5 Re-conditioning
at VERY MODERATE CHARGES
K.N.S. RAJAN SERVICES
76671 33233
93818 03956

SPOKEN ENGLISH PRACTICAL CLASSES FOR PROFESSIONALS & OFFICE GOERS
OUTDOOR CLASS ONLY
MEN ONLY
Prof. V.M. Balakumar, M.A., M.P.C.
98413 - 36727

To advertise in
DOWNTOWN
Contact:
UDHAYAKUMAR
81246 14787

BUYING ANY CONDITION
LED, OLED, CTvs, Music System, Sound Bars, Genset, Bureau, Laptops, Computers, A/c's, Stabilizers, Geyser, Motor, Fridges, Machineries, W.Machines, Android Phones, Battery, Invertors, Old cars & Bikes for Best Price
Sweatha Electronics
93827 28672/93827 28677

Estd.: 1969
GARMENT CLEANERS
A Unit of Liberty Dry Cleaners
KODAMBAKKAM BRANCH
Shop No.B6, Salma Arcade Building, Basement Floor, Door No.333, Arcot Road, Kodambakkam, Chennai - 600 024. (Opp. Ganapathi Hr. Sec. School)
Cell: 90032 82896

STACK PARKING TECHNOLOGIES PRIVATE LIMITED
CUSTOMIZABLE, COST-EFFECTIVE MULTI-LEVEL CAR PARKING
Street parking ends here. Park inside. Stay safe. No Sun, No Rain, No Risk
98414 46022 / 044-24450357

Two-day property expo in September



The Hindu Property Expo - 2026 will be held on September 5 and 6 at Chennai Trade Centre, Nandambakkam.

Visitors can explore a wide range of premium residences, plots, farmlands, farmhouses, commercial spaces, and investment opportunities. The expo offers an opportunity to meet developers, compare projects, understand available options, and make informed property decisions.

Scan the QR code to register or visit: newsth.live/PFC2026PA

For details, call 9841273713 / 9841810070



Payasam mela and Onam sadhya

Rain Drops, the hospitality venture from Kerala Tourism Development Hotels and Resorts at Greaves Road, is celebrating the Onam with a payasam mela and traditional Onam sadya till August 26.

The payasam mela features a delightful variety of traditional Kerala payasams. The highlights include pineapple payasam, chakka payasam, pazham payasam, palada payasam, parippu pradhman, ada pradhman, kadala parippu payasam, carrot payasam, paal payasam and gothambu payasam.

A traditional Onam sadya will be served on August 23rd and August 26th with 29 items. A special buffet Onam sadya will also be available, featuring an array of authentic Kerala delicacies.

Cost of payasam is ₹450 per litre and ₹280 for half litre; Onam sadya is ₹899 per person and buffet sadya is ₹599 per person.

The Onam celebrations were inaugurated on August 21 by Rajya Sabha member Praveen Chakravarty.

For bookings and enquiries, WhatsApp: 9498410098, 9188127752 | Phone: 044-28292150



A 'Hunger Project'

Lions Club Of Chennai Global Synergy feeds 3,300 people in one month

As part of its mass community feeding programme, Lions Club of Chennai Global Synergy has provided food and water to over 3,300 people under its Hunger Project in different parts of Chennai city over the last four weeks.

Club Treasurer Lion B. Anbumani and World Guinness Record Hol-

der for making heavy idlis, Lion Idli Eniyavan, were the main contributors to the initiative.

On August 15, Lion Anbumani provided food to over 120 senior citizens at Akshaya Trust Free Old Age Home in Valasaravakkam and quenched the thirst of over 2,000 devotees at a temple as part of his birthday celebrations.

Lion Eniyavan provided snacks to over 700 athletes, 150 senior citizens and 350 artists on different occasions.

Akshaya Trust commemorated the 80th Independence Day with the hoisting of the national flag by

Club President Lion N. Anand in the presence of fellow Lions and inmates.

Founded by Lion F. Mohammed Thahir, Lions Club of Chennai Global Synergy is an 18-month-old club that has been carrying out service initiatives in the areas of hunger, vision, environment, child care and youth welfare, KIM Lions Hospital, Soorya School of Music, Udhavum Karangal and Akshaya Trust.

Akshaya Trust in-charge Bhuvaneshwari and the inmates thanked the club members and conveyed their blessings to Lion Anbumani and birthday boy Lion P. Duraivel.

Sadya at Sangeetha Veg

On August 26, Sangeetha Veg Restaurant is serving the traditional Onam sadya.

The sadya will feature crisp banana chips, 'sarkara upperi', 'pachadi', 'thoran', 'kootu curry', 'olan', 'kalan' and 'inji puli', along with pickles, 'pappadam', 'pazham', 'parippu' and 'nei', more 'kachiyathu' and other accompaniments. The feast culminates in the irresistible 'pradhman'.

The Onam sadya at Sangeetha Veg is served at its three outlets - Adyar (9003003087), Virugambakam (7823958667), and Anna Nagar (8680001379) from 11 a.m. to 3 p.m. Dine-in bookings can be made at No. 9003003090. Customers can also book for takeaway and home delivery within a 3-kilometer radius. The Onam sadya can also be ordered online through Swiggy and Zomato, said a release.



Coffee House opens third outlet in Chennai



Cafe Coffee House has opened its third outlet, located on Dr Thirumoorthy Nagar Main Road, near GG Hospital, Nungambakkam.

The evening launch was marked by music and special offers, bringing together family, friends, and influencers.

The menu at the outlet includes burgers, pizzas, sandwiches, wraps, pasta, fried chicken, seafood, grilled

dishes, and snacks, as well as coffee and other beverages.

Kishore, the outlet founder, says the idea of opening a cafe outlet stemmed from an experience when he was studying in college.

"During my college days, menus at cafes were expensive and would cost around ₹350. My pocket money at the time was around ₹100-₹150. The outlet will offer a café-style experience at more approachable prices."

Temple cleaning drive held



Members of Sri Krishna Sweets, T. Nagar, in association with YACD - Gopalapuram took part in Paramam Pavithram, a temple cleaning programme held in Puttaparthi. According to a press, around 48 volunteers participated.

A cleaning drive was also held at Sri Sathya Sai Super Speciality Hospital and Goshala (shelter for cows) in Puttaparthi, adds the press release.

**GERIATRIC
CARE CENTRE**
OP & IP

**FOOD AND OTHERS
AMENITIES PROVIDED
MEDICAL SERVICE
AT REDUCED COST**

MAYA NURSING HOME PVT. LTD
B225, 15th Avenue, Ashok Nagar, Chennai 83
9940396922 / 9962370552